QUAIN

NETWORKING

A small, *trusted* circle.

A professional foundation of trusted relationships that we build in good times, so we can rely on it when we need it.

Nicolas Moegelin · Berlin, Germany

Final presentation · Digitale Leute Product Management Bootcamp · 08–11 / 2026

• QUAIN AT A GLANCE

Curated Seasons for *trusted* relationships.

Networking for **(senior) Product Professionals** that feels more like making friends.

Season

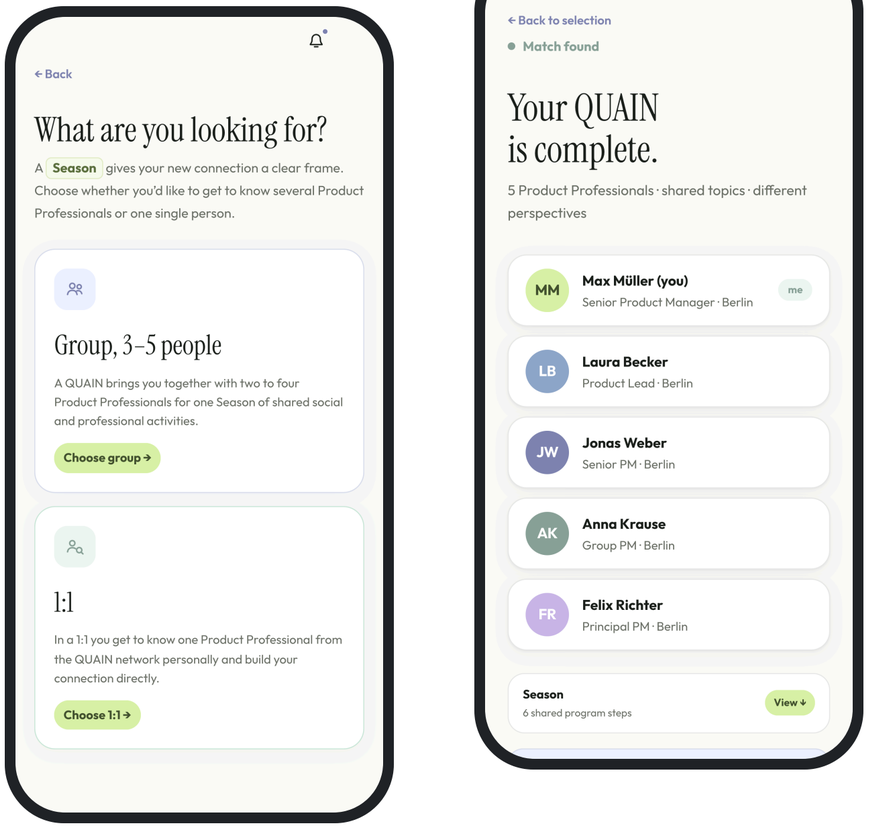
1:1s or 3–5	6 months	6 activities
people per Season	leave without bad vibes	no meeting feeling

VISION [2]

A professional foundation of trusted relationships that we build in good times, so we can rely on it when we need it.

MISSION [2]

As a digital curator, we use offline and online formats deliberately to create encounters that grow into reliable relationships rather than loose contacts.



[1]

• THE PROBLEM

Out of *sight*, out of mind.

Valuable contacts get lost once shared work or occasions end and are missing later. [3]

3 OF 3 INTERVIEWS

"... [after a job or project change] it usually fizzles out after two years at the latest."

Interview 01 · translated [4]

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"Yes, how do I tell him now [after a long time without contact] that I'm looking for a job, that's actually awkward."

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"... I always cancel the [monthly]. Somehow I can't cancel the series yet, because I don't dare to."

Interview 02 · translated [5]

WHAT HOLDS

"Our project lead is now [...] the one I [...] go running with, [...] that's how I talk through some things."

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TAKEAWAY

Shared activities *connect* and make room for professional exchange.

• WHY IT MATTERS

Trusted connections raise *quality* and output.

Exchange among peers leads to new perspectives and speeds up professional growth. *That* is what customers pay for.

STUDIES · B2B2C AND B2C

Connection is linked to performance.

- More friendships in the team, better performance ratings. [18]
- Co-workers shape attitudes and effectiveness, not only leadership. [19]
- Teams with bridges to other teams are more innovative. [20]

INTERVIEW INSIGHT

"… [after talking to a colleague in the same role] I completely changed my strategy again, […] one I simply hadn't come up with myself."

Interview 03 · translated [21]

• THE SOLUTION

A circle with a beginning and an *end*.

Every Season has a fixed start, six activities and a clear ending that makes leaving easy. [7]

STEP 1/4

Choose 1:1 or group

STEP 2/4

Profile & matching [7]

1. Professional focus
2. Personal interests
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Based on this, QUAIN matches participants and creates activities.

STEP 3/4 **Season** · 6 months, 6 program steps



STEP 4/4

Leave / continue [7]

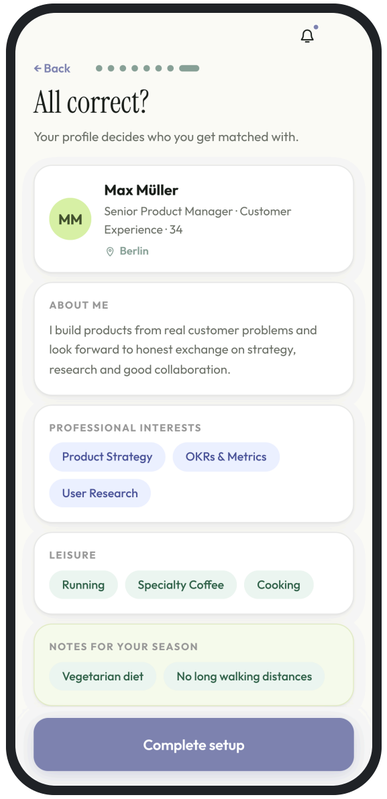
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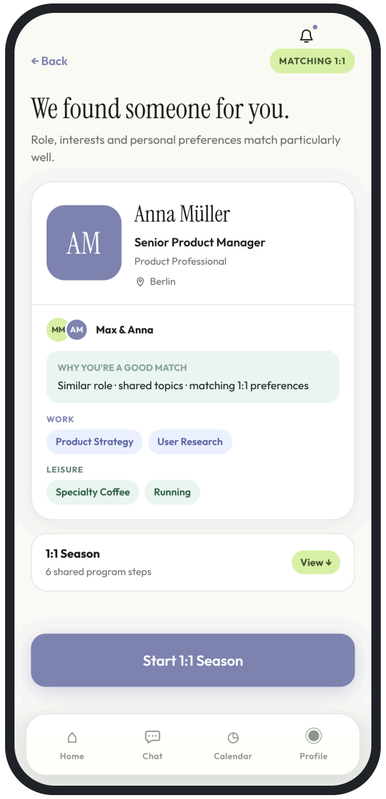
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From profile to *Season*.

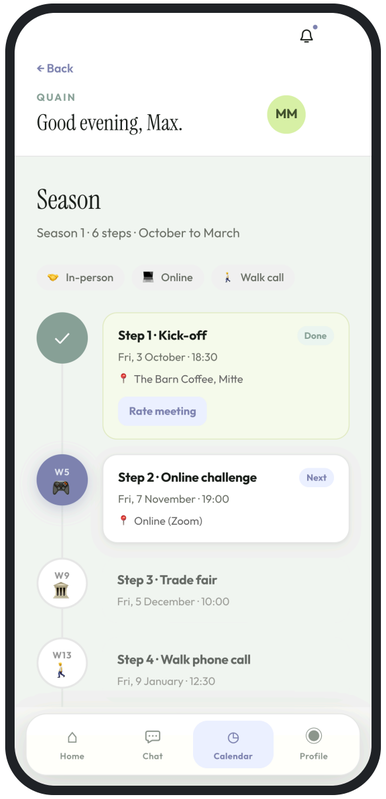
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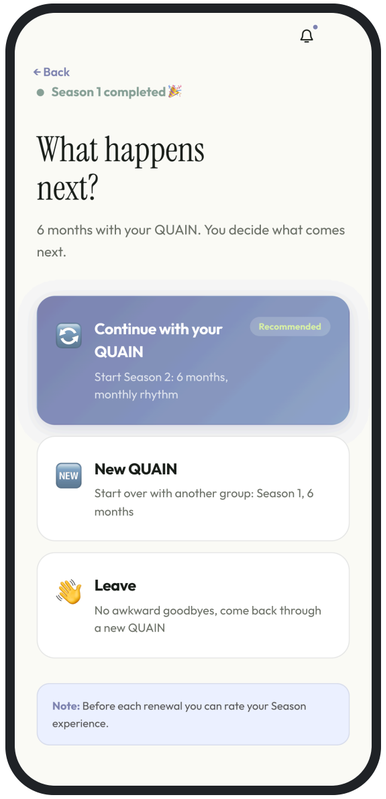
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Matching



Planning



End of Season

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B2C proves, B2B *scales*.

We start with private subscriptions and grow through companies that book places for their product teams.

B2C · GO-TO-MARKET

Private QUAIN

Who pays: the user

€9.90 per month
from Season start[7]

- Freemium: sign-up and contacts free of charge
- ≈ €118.80 per person and year
- Stays with you when you change jobs

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private subscriptions equal one company customer

B2C → B2B

Happy users bring QUAIN into their company.

B2B2C · SCALING

Corporate QUAIN

Who pays: HR / Learning & Development

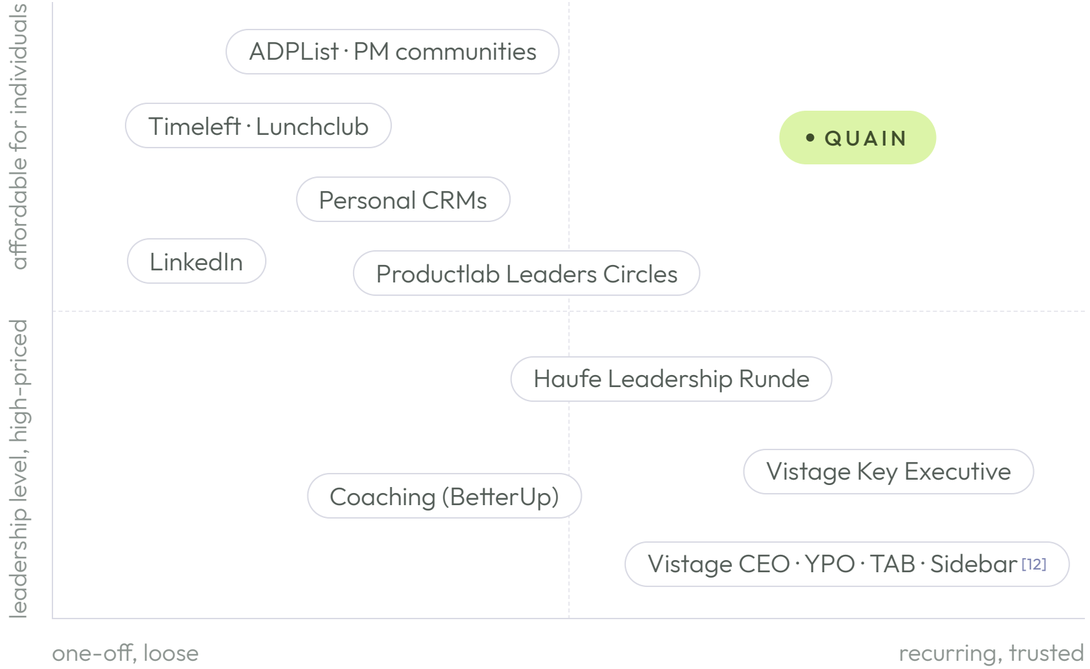
€75 per person and month
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- Avg. 15 places ≈ €16,500 per company and year
- Pilot: one Season at €45 per person
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• COMPETITION

Proven mechanism, *new* goal.

Moderated C-level peer groups have existed for decades, at C-level prices. [6, 12]



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- builds relationships through shared experiences
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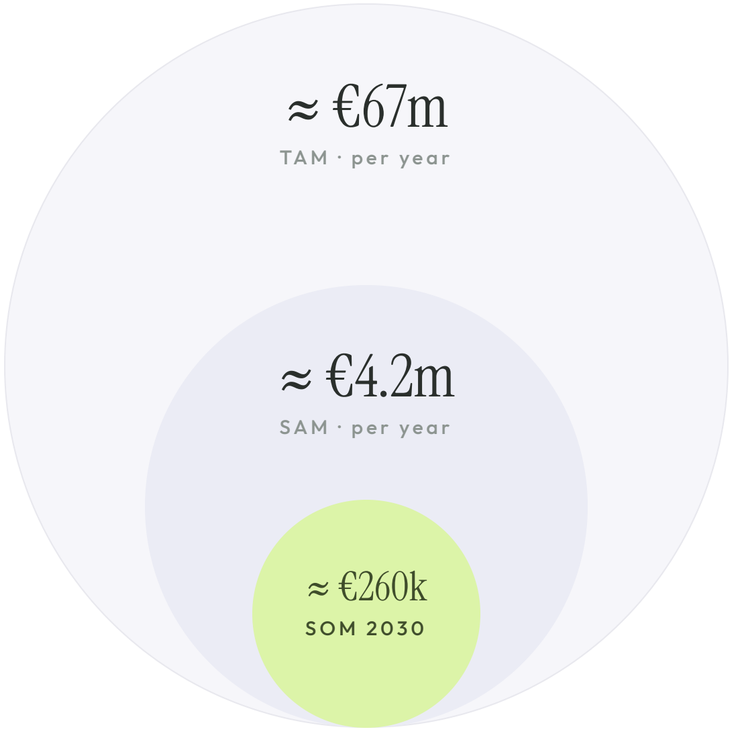
WHAT THE MARKET DOESN'T SOLVE · OWN ASSESSMENT

- **LinkedIn:** many loose contacts, labour-intensive (posting)
- **Events / meetups:** one-off, networking depends on personality
- **Personal CRMs:** create no shared moments
- **C-level peer forums:** exclusive (high costs) [6]

• MARKET

≈ 35,000 senior PMs in *Germany* alone.

Planning assumption: a clear niche, large enough to grow city by city without venture capital.



TAM — Product roles in Europe — ≈ 567,000 people

567,000 × €118.80 per year (12 × €9.90) ≈ €67m per year

Assumption based on Product Focus, LinkedIn count 10/2023[9]

SAM — Senior and aspiring-senior PMs in Germany — ≈ 35,000 people

100,000 product roles in DE × 35 % = 35,000 × €118.80 ≈ €4.2m per year

Planning assumption: the Product Focus Survey 2026 reports 46 % senior PMs; because roles are self-assessed, we deduct about 10 percentage points[10, 11]

SOM 2030 — Paying B2C users + B2B company customers — ≈ 800 people + 10 companies

B2C ≈ €95,000* + B2B €165,000** (10 companies) ≈ €260k per year

* Assumption B2C: 5 cities × avg. 40 groups × avg. 4 people = 800 people × €9.90 × 12 months ≈ €95,000[10]

** Assumption B2B: 15 people × €75 × 12 months + €250 base fee × 12 months = €16,500 per company[13]

• DELIVERY · RELEASE PLAN

From prototype to *market*, step by step.

Agile roadmap: *Now* in the next 3 months, *Next* in the next 6 months, *Later* after that. [22]

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Test the Figma Make prototype with 8 people in interviews.
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Detect problems and bugs early via Supabase and Stripe and fix them fast.

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Ads in relevant communities, e.g. Reddit.
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Further user stories from the story map

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> 60 %	Retention rate: Seasons completed and renewed
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4 of 5	stars after every activity and every Season

Two futures, five *open* questions.

Two fictional interviews from 2036 show what has to work. [17]

BEST CASE

Julia K., 41

Senior Product Manager · HR tech scale-up, Berlin

"At some point, QUAIN became indispensable."

18 SEASONS IN NINE YEARS

Company insolvent, three conversations in one week.

Never organised anything, just showed up.

The end of the first circle didn't hurt.

Happily paid every month for 18 Seasons.

Berlin 2027: the first group starts.

OPEN QUESTION

H1 · H2
Does trust emerge that holds?

H3 · H4
Does a fixed program fit everyday life?

H5
Does leaving work without bad vibes?

H6
Does the value justify the monthly fee?

H8
Are there enough people per city?

WORST CASE

Daniel M., 44

Senior Product Manager · logistics SME, Cologne

"We were nice, but never honest."

NINE SEASONS IN EIGHT YEARS

Nine Seasons and no one I would call.

The dates were fixed, my calendar wasn't.

Started a new Season because the others probably would.

Paying for something like friendship doesn't fit.

Cologne 2028: the first QUAIN doesn't start.

CUSTOMER LONGEVITY

How do we keep interest and curiosity alive in the long run?

B2B WILLINGNESS TO PAY

Are companies / HR departments willing to pay?
If so, how much?

Where the *statements* come from.

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04_develop/quain/quain.md

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productfocus.com · register 01_discover/sekundaerforschung/quellen.md

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03_strategy/markt-wachstum/ (build_markt_wachstum.py, one-pager)

[11] Product Focus Industry Survey Report 2026 (n = 677, 40 countries, self-assessed role: 46 % senior PM, 24 % head of and above)
productfocus.com · register quellen.md

[12] Vistage and YPO, self-reported: About Vistage (since 1957, ≈ 45,000 members), What is Vistage (groups of 12–16), Vistage “Best Leadership Training Companies” 04/2026 ($2,500 initiation + $1,380 per month ≈ $16,500 per year); About YPO (since 1950)
vistage.com · register quellen.md

[13] B2B offer: prices, base fee, pilot
03_strategy/b2b-angebot/b2b-angebot-onepager.html

[14] Strategy on one page: channels and target group
03_strategy/strategy.md

[15] B2C test Berlin: process and thresholds
03_strategy/b2c-test/b2c-test-onepager.html

[16] 1:1 self-test, own statement Nicolas (November 2026)
not documented in the repository

[17] PRFAQ: Working Backwards as a method
03_strategy/prfaq/quain-prfaq.md

[18] Methot, LePine, Podsakoff & Christian (2016): Are Workplace Friendships a Mixed Blessing? Personnel Psychology 69(2), n = 168/182, correlational
doi.org/10.1111/peps.12109

[19] Chiaburu & Harrison (2008): meta-analysis on the influence of co-workers, J. of Applied Psychology 93(5), 161 samples, 77,954 employees, correlational
doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.93.5.1082

[20] Yan, Venkataramani, Tang & Hirst (2024): Navigating Inter-Team Competition, J. of Applied Psychology, 73 teams (field) and 162 teams (experiment)
doi.org/10.1037/apl0001216

[21] Interview 03, transcript (verbatim quote, German, 35:26): evidence for change of perspective (KP5, ●◯◯, I03 only)
01_discover/Interviews/interview-03/fathom-transkript.md

[22] Agile roadmap (Now/Next/Later) and story map with releases, Miro (delivery exercise)
Miro board · not documented in the repository

[23] Own web research (11 Nov 2026), 18 providers, incl. Productlab, Delight Path, Supra, Boye & Co, Timeleft, 222, Pie; mostly self-reported by providers, no claim to completeness
Fact check 2026-11-11

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Folie 1 Folie 2

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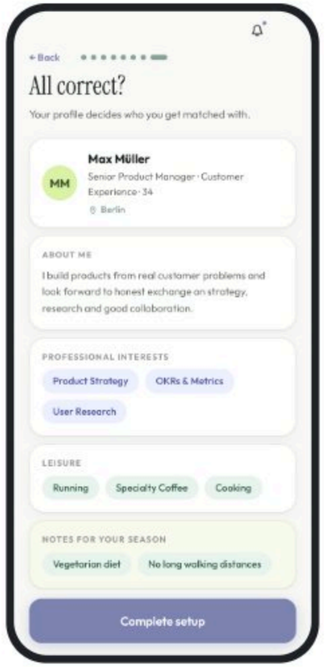
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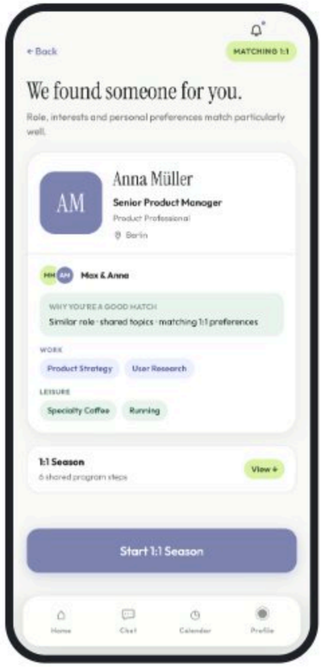
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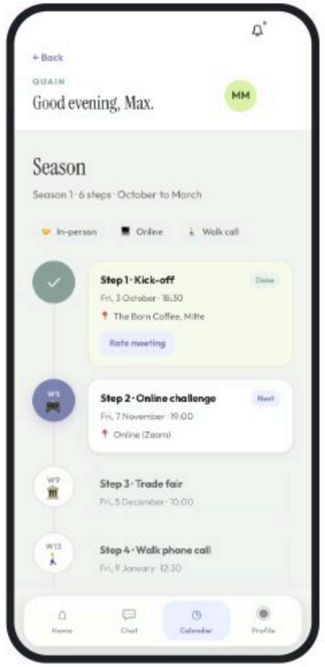
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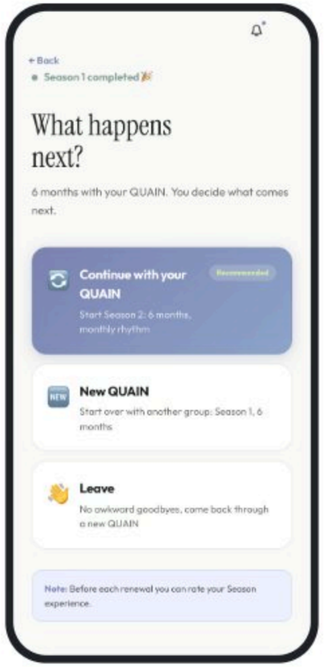
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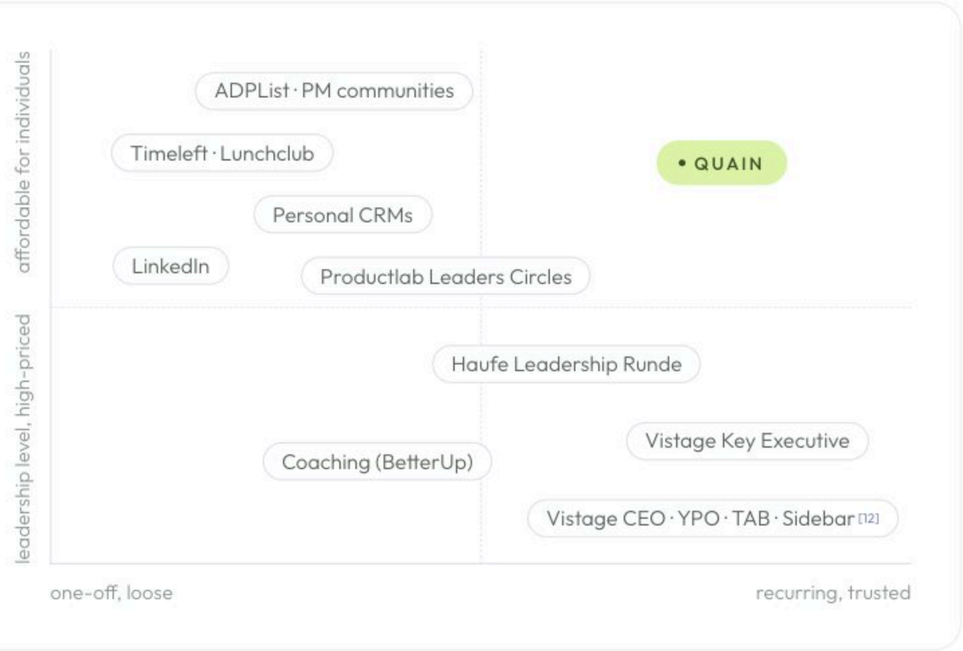
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Berlin 2027: the first group starts.	H8 Are there enough people per city?	Cologne 2028: the first QUAIN doesn't start.

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[12] Vistage and YPO, self-reported: About Vistage (since 1957, ≈ 45,000 members), What is Vistage (groups of 12–16), Vistage "Best Leadership Training Companies" 04/2026 ($2,500 initiation + $1,380 per month ≈ $16,500 per year); About YPO (since 1950)
vistage.com · register quellen.md

[13] B2B offer: prices, base fee, pilot
03_strategy/b2b-angebot/b2b-angebot-onepager.html

[14] Strategy on one page: channels and target group
03_strategy/strategy.md

[15] B2C test Berlin: process and thresholds
03_strategy/b2c-test/b2c-test-onepager.html

[16] 1:1 self-test, own statement Nicolas (November 2026)
not documented in the repository

[17] PRFAQ: Working Backwards as a method
03_strategy/prfaq/quain-prfaq.md

[18] Methot, LePine, Podsakoff & Christian (2016): Are Workplace Friendships a Mixed Blessing? Personnel Psychology 69(2), n = 168/182, correlational
doi.org/10.1111/peps.12109

[19] Chiaburu & Harrison (2008): meta-analysis on the influence of co-workers, J. of Applied Psychology 93(5), 161 samples, 77,954 employees, correlational
doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.93.5.1082

[20] Yan, Venkataramani, Tang & Hirst (2024): Navigating Inter-Team Competition, J. of Applied Psychology, 73 teams (field) and 162 teams (experiment)
doi.org/10.1037/apl0001216

[21] Interview 03, transcript (verbatim quote, German, 35:26): evidence for change of perspective (KP5, ●◯◯, I03 only)
01_discover/Interviews/interview-03/fathom-transkript.md

[22] Agile roadmap (Now/Next/Later) and story map with releases, Miro (delivery exercise)
Miro board · not documented in the repository

[23] Own web research (11 Nov 2026), 18 providers, incl. Productlab, Delight Path, Supra, Boye & Co, Timeleft, 222, Pie; mostly self-reported by providers, no claim to completeness
Fact check 2026-11-11